independently of him. He glanced at it and said, "Why don't you put this effort into your research?"

I said angrily, "I did this on my own time."

And he said, "A research worker doesn't have his own time."

It was clear then, if it had not been abundantly clear before, that he and I were not on the same wavelength. It was probably at that moment that I came to the conscious decision that I was no longer a research chemist and that I would never again be one. If either Lemon, or the school itself, ever tried to make me become one, they would find they couldn't.

Let me make it clear that I was turning against research and not against teaching. I loved teaching, and the textbook was a form of teaching. I particularly loved lecturing

There could be no question but that my teaching was satisfactory. I had improved steadily in the organization, drama, and interest in my lecture presentations. (This would seem to be my own estimate of the situation, but I know the students agreed with me.)

On April 15, 1952, I gave my final lecture of the third teaching semester in which I had been involved. It was "Heat and Work," and somewhere in the middle, I delivered a ringing sentence on the concept of the "heat death" of the Universe, and there followed a wild and enthusiastic peal of applause that did not allow me to continue for quite a while.

A story reached me once that on another floor, a member of the Physiology Department said, "What's that?" at the sound of distant laughter and applause.

Another member said, "Probably Asimov lecturing."

And it was.

There's no question about it in my mind, and I'm willing to say it without hesitation, that I was the best lecturer in the school, and at no time ever did I skimp my teaching duties in favor of my writing.

My talent for lecturing was not something I hid under a bushel, and with much of the faculty (not all) this did not tend to make me a beloved comrade. What with my general eccentricity and self-asser-tiveness, and with my refusal to take part in academic social functions, I remained rather isolated